

GreenLeaf E-Commerce – Tabletop Exercise Script

Facilitator: Cameron Naidoo (GRC Analyst) | Date: 24/06/2026

Duration: 1 Hour | Participants: CTO, CEO, Legal, PR, Scribe

SCENARIO OPENING:

Facilitator reads aloud:

"Good morning. Today is a typical Tuesday. It is 9:00 AM. The CTO receives an alert from the antivirus software on the main server. The alert says: '*Ransomware detected – files are being encrypted.*' The CTO rushes to the server room and sees a ransom note on the monitor demanding \$50,000 in Bitcoin."

EXERCISE PHASE 1: INITIAL RESPONSE (Minutes 0–15)

Facilitator asks the CTO:

"What do you do immediately? Please describe your first three actions, including containment and evidence preservation."

Facilitator asks the Scribe:

"What are you recording right now?"

Facilitator asks the CEO:

"The CTO tells you the server is infected. What is your first question to the CTO?"

EXERCISE PHASE 2: ESCALATION (Minutes 15–30)

Facilitator injects a twist:

"The CTO has unplugged the server and captured the ransom note. However, the CTO realizes they do not have the phone number for the forensic investigator. The retainer agreement was never signed. The CEO calls the legal department, but legal is on a different time zone and not answering."

Facilitator asks the CEO:

"What do you do next? Do you pay the ransom without the investigator? Do you try to find an investigator on Google? What is your decision?"

EXERCISE PHASE 3: RECOVERY (Minutes 30–45)

Facilitator moves time forward:

"It is now 11:00 AM. The forensic investigator has been engaged (after a delay). They have confirmed that the attacker used a compromised admin account to gain access. The server has been wiped and restored from the cloud backup (which, we discovered, was last tested 6 months ago). The website is back online."

Facilitator asks the PR Lead:

"Customers are calling the support line asking if their data has been stolen. What do you tell them?"

Facilitator asks the Scribe:

"What are the key things you have written down in the log?"

EXERCISE PHASE 4: LESSONS LEARNED (Minutes 45–60)

Facilitator concludes:

"The attack is over, but GreenLeaf has significant gaps. The CTO had no retainer agreement. The cloud backup had not been tested in 6 months. The Scribe did not record the exact times of containment."

Facilitator asks the team:

"What are the THREE biggest things GreenLeaf must fix to prevent this from happening again?"

EXERCISE CLOSE:

Facilitator thanks the team and shares a summary of the findings, which will be added to the Incident Response Plan as "Lessons Learned."